Case Study: Rise

Payroll as the Labour Layer

Rise operates hybrid fiat-crypto payroll for international teams, letting employers fund payroll in fiat or stablecoins while each worker selects their own payout mix, with withdrawal data tracked by volume, currency (fiat and stablecoin), and country across Latin America (Source: Rise company data).

Stablecoins account for over 90% of crypto payroll transactions globally, with USDC at a 63% share of crypto salaries and USDT at 28.6%; freelancers have led adoption, with over 25% globally opting for partial crypto payments, concentrated in software development and design roles (Source: Rise Stablecoin Payroll Report). Platform withdrawal data shows sustained Latam demand for stablecoin payout options, with Argentina the emblematic market (Source: Rise company data).

Payroll and remittances together represented roughly $90 billion of 2025's real stablecoin payment volume, the second-largest category after B2B (Source: Stablecoin Insider analysis of McKinsey/Artemis data). In Latam the driver is the inflation dynamic documented in Chapter 2: workers in markets like Argentina converting pay into digital dollars on salary dates (Source: Dune / Bitso).

By offering stablecoin payout options, companies gain access to highly skilled talent pools in countries experiencing persistent inflation, while professionals in those markets gain access to international employers who were previously deterred by payment complexity and currency volatility.

Removing the payment barrier changed the labour market itself, and adoption has moved well beyond crypto-native firms into agencies, startups, and global businesses with international teams (Source: Rise company data).

The biggest misconception about stablecoin payroll is that it's only for crypto companies.

What we're seeing today is agencies, startups, and global businesses adopting stablecoin payroll because it simply works better for international teams.

Hugo Finkelstein

CEO, Rise

Case Study: VelaFi

the Asia-Latam Corridor End to End

VelaFi serves import/export companies, logistics firms, fintechs, and cross-border e-commerce that need to move money across regions without setting up a legal entity in every country, and a growing base of SMBs with cross-border supplier relationships, resolving Latam's local-rail fragmentation (SPEI, PIX, CVU, Bre-B) through a single integration covering the corridor end-to-end (Source: VelaFi company data).

The platform processed 300%+ volume growth in 2025 versus 2024, driven primarily by import/export and logistics clients, with 20%+ growth recorded in the three months to mid-2026 alone. **VelaFi now serves 1,000+ institutional clients across 200+ countries and territories**, with cross-border e-commerce emerging as a new segment. Supplier payments concentrate most of the volume; treasury use cases remain early. SMBs are the fastest-growing segment, a pace the company expects to hold into 2026 as the corridor matures (Source: VelaFi company data).

The Asia-Latam corridor operates under fundamentally different conditions than mature cross-border flows: higher FX volatility, a more complex compliance environment, and substantial per-country differences in regulatory frameworks, FX controls, and preferred payment methods on the Latam side, which means the bar for infrastructure quality is higher, not lower (Source: VelaFi company data). Globally, the destinations mirror this: China Mainland and Hong Kong are the second- and third-largest recipients of cross-border stablecoin payments (Source: The Defiant).

The most significant shift VelaFi observes is not in the corridor's mechanics but in who is showing up to use it: **demand is broadening beyond the import/export and logistics companies** that built the corridor's early volume, and SMBs that previously had no path into cross-border stablecoin infrastructure are actively seeking it out, **a different growth pattern that signals where the next phase of volume comes from** (Source: VelaFi company data).

“

Everyone assumes this corridor will be won on technology: speed, APIs, blockchain rails. It won't.

It'll be won by whoever understands both sides well enough to make compliance and local knowledge invisible to the customer.

That's a much harder thing to build than a faster rail, and it's why we think the market will consolidate hard over the next two years.

Maggie Wu

CEO & Co-Founder, VelaFi

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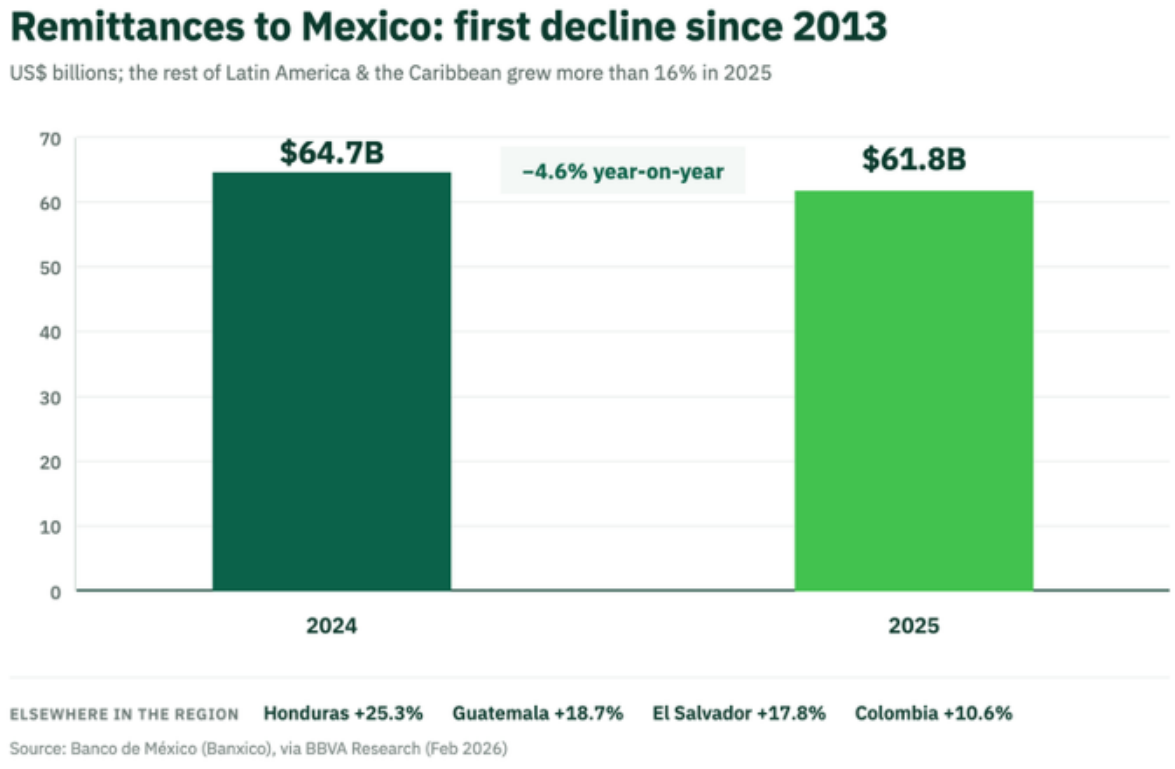
The Corridors

The Corridors: Latam-US, Latam-Asia, Intra-Latam

Latam-US: remittances and B2B

Flow types: consumer remittances (south-bound), contractor/payroll payouts (south-bound), B2B supplier and services payments (both directions).

The US-Mexico corridor is the largest single remittance corridor in the world. Mexico received $61.8 billion in 2025, down 4.6% from the record $64.7 billion in 2024, the first annual decline since 2013 and the largest since 2009, with more than 95% originating in the United States; the drop reflects reduced migration flows, tightened enforcement, and a stronger peso rather than any change in the underlying dependence (Sources: Latin Times, citing Banxico; FXC Intelligence). Remittances to the rest of Latin America and the Caribbean grew by more than 16% in the same year (Source: BBVA Research).



Legacy transfers on this corridor carry the global cost structure documented in Chapter 2: a **6.36% average, with banks at 14.99%** (Source: World Bank RPW). In production systems, stablecoin rails offer 24/7 availability with no batch windows, while regulated local rails handle origination and last mile disbursement, each with its own off-ramp and compliance requirements per market (Source: Movantis company data).

The disbursement reality confirms the architecture: of Mexico's electronically received remittances, **49.6% is still collected in cash at physical payout locations, and remittances sent as bank deposits account for the other 50.4%**, a last mile no blockchain reaches without a licensed physical network (Source: Mexico News Daily, citing Banxico).

Regulatory context: US origination now operates under the GENIUS Act's federal stablecoin framework (Source: Forbes). Mexico's 2018 Fintech Law permits public crypto use but bars regulated financial institutions from offering virtual-asset services directly to customers, pushing stablecoin activity through exchanges and specialised providers; a May 2026 Senate initiative (the Murat Initiative) would create a formal regime for peso-referenced stablecoins across ten financial laws (Sources: CCN; Legal Paradox).

Everyone says they can serve this corridor. **Very few can do the daily compliance and operational work it actually takes, and most quietly let go once they try.**

What's left are the teams with real local depth on both ends. That difficulty isn't a problem to solve. It's the reason this corridor rewards the operators who stay.

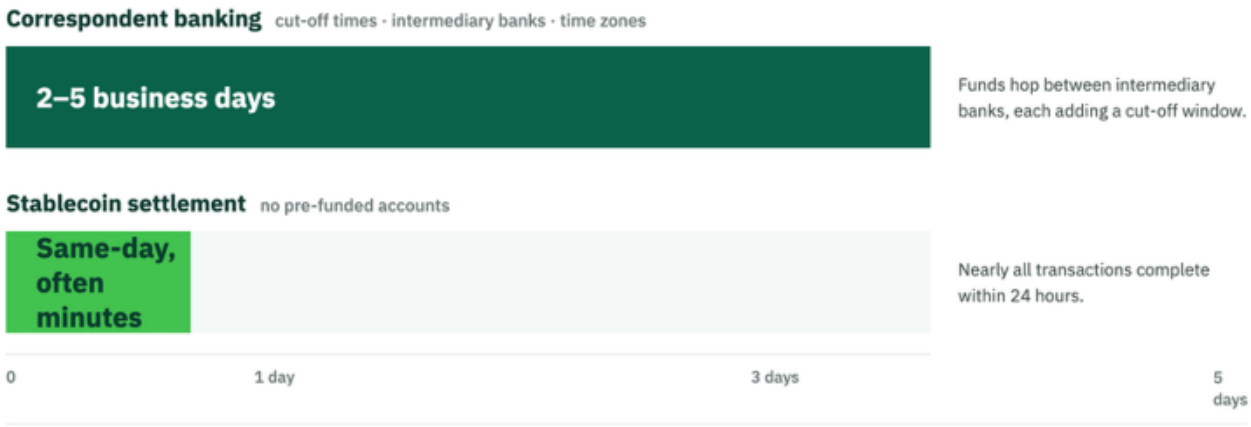


Maggie Wu,
CEO & Co-Founder, VelaFi

Latam-Asia: the trade corridor

Flow types: import supplier payments (dominant), inventory purchases, procurement, logistics settlement.

This is the corridor where stablecoins have most decisively displaced correspondent banking, because the legacy alternative was worst here: historically, trade payments between Latin America and Asia required 2-5 business days to settle, with delays from intermediary banks, cut-off times, compliance reviews, and time-zone differences frequently impacting working capital and supplier relationships (Source: Mandioca company data). Globally, the destination data confirms the pattern: China is the second-largest recipient of cross-border stablecoin payments at nearly $71 billion per month on average, with Hong Kong third at almost $51 billion (Source: The Defiant / Artemis).



Latam→Mainland China and Latam→Hong Kong rank among the fastest-growing corridors for trade-settlement platforms, with typical tickets of USD 20,000-250,000 and settlement compressed to same-day or minutes (Source: Mandioca company data). Corridor-specialist volume grew 300%+ in 2025, with SMBs, which have no treasury team and no banking relationship able to absorb a slow settlement, as the fastest-growing segment (Source: VelaFi company data). **The corridor carries higher FX volatility and a more complex compliance environment than mature corridors**, which raises rather than lowers the bar for infrastructure quality; successful settlement requires local knowledge on both ends, from business culture and payment-timing expectations to the per-country nuances of SPEI, PIX, CVU, and Bre-B (Source: VelaFi company data).

Regulatory context. On the Latam side, each market is its own regime, and Brazil's is changing fastest (see 6.4). On the Asia side, corridor operators navigate Mainland China, Hong Kong, and Southeast Asian frameworks that differ market by market, one reason the corridor rewards operators with regulated presence on both ends (Source: VelaFi company data).

Intra-Latam: the untapped family

Flow types: regional trade, marketplace settlement, intercompany treasury flows, cross-border consumer payments

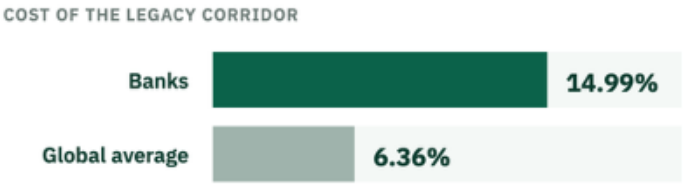
Intra-regional flows are structurally underdeveloped relative to the region's trade: **there is no shared currency, no shared rail, and no interoperability between national instant-payment systems, meaning two adjacent economies often settle through New York**. Stablecoins are emerging as the de facto regional interoperability layer between PIX, SPEI, CVU, Nequi, and Bre-B, with the cross-border leg on-chain and each disbursement leg landing on the destination market's local rail, the same architecture documented across every corridor in this report.

The last mile keeps strengthening on its own trajectory: **PIX processed 79.8 billion transactions in 2025 and is discussing replication and connection with central banks in dozens of countries**, while Colombia's Bre-B connected 218 financial institutions and 33 million users within six months of launch (Sources: PaymentBrief; FiscalNote). As these systems scale, the missing piece is not domestic capability but the settlement bridge between them, which is precisely the gap the stablecoin layer fills.

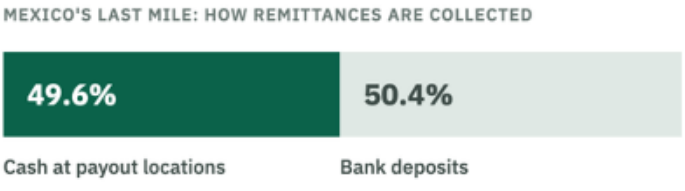
Stablecoins take the middle leg, not the whole corridor

Where each leg of a remittance actually runs in production systems





Average total cost to send $200 (Chapter 2 baseline).



Nearly half of electronically received remittances are still picked up as cash — a last mile no blockchain reaches without a licensed physical network.

Stablecoins compress the wholesale leg toward zero; origination and disbursement stay on regulated local rails.

Sources: World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide; Movantis company data; Mexico News Daily, citing Banxico

The regulatory map, market by market

Stablecoin rules across the region, mid-2026

Framework status by market and what it means in practice

MARKET	FRAMEWORK STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS FOR STABLECOINS
Brazil IN FORCE	Resolutions 519/520/521 (effective 2 Feb 2026); Resolution 561 (effective 1 Oct 2026)	▪ Mandatory VASP licensing ▪ Stablecoin operations classified as FX, with reporting from May 2026 ▪ Licensing transition runs to 30 Oct 2026 ▪ eFX providers barred from stablecoin settlement
Mexico PENDING	2018 Fintech Law; Murat Initiative (May 2026) pending	▪ Legal for the public, restricted for regulated institutions ▪ Peso-stablecoin (AVE) regime proposed across ten financial laws
Argentina IN FORCE	CNV PSAV registry (Res. 994/2024, 1058/2025); AML under Law 27,739	▪ VASP registration mandatory ▪ Includes foreign providers targeting residents
Colombia PARTIAL	No dedicated VASP licensing; Bre-B live	▪ Stablecoin activity operates under general AML rules ▪ Runs alongside the new instant-payment system
Bolivia UNDER REVIEW	Ban lifted 2024; USDT recognition under formal review	▪ State banks already offer USDT products ▪ Would be the region's first officially stablecoin-integrated payment framework

VASP: virtual asset service provider. Dates reflect published effective or transition deadlines as of mid-2026.

7

The CFO & Treasurer Primer

Money That Works: The CFO & Treasurer Primer

What actually changes: the benchmark table

DIMENSION	LEGACY RAILS CORRESPONDENT BANKING / SWIFT	STABLECOIN RAILS
Settlement time LATAM–Asia trade payment	2–5 business days	Same-day, often minutes; nearly all within 24 hours
Availability	Banking hours, cut-offs, time zones	24/7/365
Remittance cost $200, global average	6.36% average; banks 14.99%	On-chain fees measured in cents on high-throughput chains
Visibility	Opaque intermediary chain	Near real-time on-chain tracking
Pre-funding	Required across jurisdictions	Largely eliminated

Stablecoins carry the interbank settlement leg; origination and last-mile disbursement remain on regulated local rails.

Sources: World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide; Mandioca and Movantis company data

Why the business case is working capital, not fees

Every operator dataset in this report converges on the same conclusion: for treasury teams and CFOs, the most valuable benefit is improved cash conversion cycles and reduced liquidity requirements. Businesses no longer need to pre-fund accounts across multiple jurisdictions or hold excess working capital to manage settlement delays, and for many importers and exporters, those operational and liquidity benefits materially outweigh any direct transaction fee savings (Source: Mandioca company data).

Broader business survey data supports the same conclusion: among businesses that have used stablecoins, 41% report cost savings of 10% or more, mostly on cross-border payments, but the recurring qualitative driver is settlement certainty rather than fee arbitrage (Source: Reap, Stablecoin Statistics 2026).

The most important impact of stablecoin adoption in Latin America is not lower payment costs. **It is the ability to unlock working capital and accelerate trade.**

When settlement moves from days to minutes, businesses can buy inventory faster, pay suppliers faster, and grow without tying up additional capital.



Leandro Meneses,
Founder & CEO, Mandioca

The risk map: five risks, five mitigations

Reserve risk

Is the token backed 1:1? Post-GENIUS Act (US) and under Brazil's Resolution 520, major issuers face statutory reserve, audit, and redemption requirements; Brazil additionally requires independent proof-of-reserves certification for VASP authorisation (Source: Plasma). Mitigation: select issuers by reserve composition and attestation cadence.

Counterparty risk

The exchange, ramp, or custodian holding the position, not the blockchain, is usually the weakest link. Mitigation: licensed counterparties with segregated client assets, as Brazil now mandates under Resolution 520 (Source: Fystack).

Regulatory risk

The perimeter is moving fast. Brazil's FX reclassification brings a 3.5% IOF-Câmbio tax into scope for covered cross-border stablecoin payments from February 2026, a concrete case of a "cheap" rail acquiring fiscal cost once formalised (Source: Avalon Blockchain Consulting). Mitigation: model the regulated cost, not the on-chain cost

Operational risk

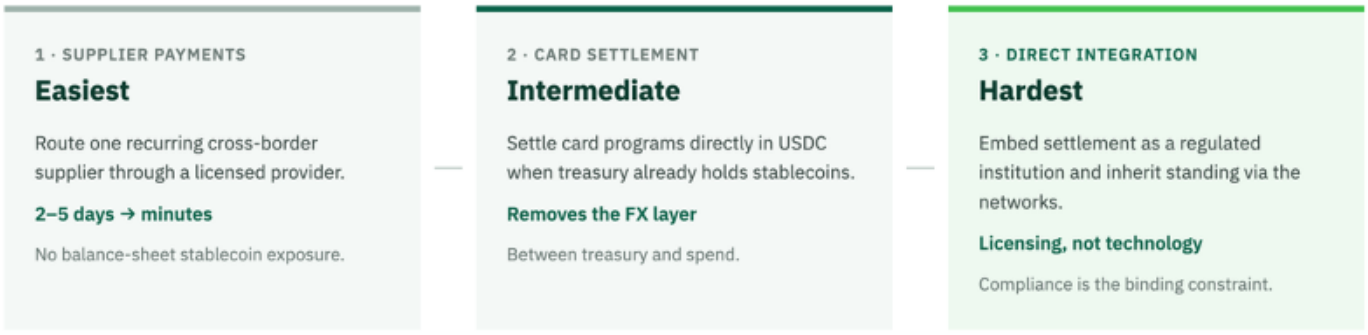
Key management, transaction finality (no recalls), address errors, chain selection. Mitigation: institutional custody, or managed-settlement products where the institution never touches the token; these are now offered at network level, with banks and PSPs interacting entirely in fiat while the network handles minting, orchestration, and compliance (Source: Bitcoin.com News).

Accounting & compliance

Dollar-pegged stablecoins held at par are generally treated as financial assets rather than volatile crypto positions, but jurisdictional treatment varies; in Brazil, cross-border stablecoin operations must be reported within the FX framework, and AML/KYB obligations apply fully at the ramp layer in every major Latam jurisdiction (Source: Plasma).

Three practical entry points, easiest to hardest

Sequenced together, these three steps walk a treasury from a single supplier invoice to full institutional integration, with each stage reversible and each independently ROI-positive.



Each stage stands alone: a team can stop after step one and keep the gain.

Sources: Mandioca, Pomelo and Movantis company data

Entry point 1: Supplier payments (easiest)

Route one recurring cross-border supplier relationship through a licensed stablecoin settlement provider. The benchmark to beat: 2-5 days compressed to minutes-to-same-day, pre-funding eliminated (Source: Mandioca company data). This requires no balance-sheet stablecoin exposure, since conversion happens at the moment of payment, and produces an immediately measurable working-capital result that finance leadership can evaluate after a single quarter.

Entry point 2: Card settlement for spend (intermediate)

If the company already holds stablecoin treasury, common for crypto-native and increasingly for globally distributed businesses, settle corporate or user card programs directly in USDC and eliminate the FX layer between treasury and spend. Program design follows the local/global card economics documented in Chapter 5: an 80/20 versus 90-95% cross-border mix, with domestic transactions costing roughly 5-15% of cross-border ones (Source: Pomelo company data).

Entry point 3: Direct institutional integration (hardest)

For a bank, money transmitter, or fintech embedding stablecoin settlement in its own product, the constraint is not technology: the rail integration is the fast part. The hard part is licensing in each market, a compliance framework that holds across jurisdictions, access to local liquidity, and integration with the local payment rails the beneficiary actually uses. These are the compliance barriers every entry point eventually hits at scale (Source: Movantis company data).

The practical 2026 route is inheritance rather than assembly: connect through networks that already hold regulated standing on both ends of the corridor, rather than building that posture country by country.

When your treasury is already in stablecoins and you're issuing cards to users globally,

eliminating that FX layer isn't just a cost optimization, it's **unlocking an entirely new operating model** where issuers can run payment infrastructure that mirrors their native rails.



Abdul Assal,
Pomelo's General Manager of Global Card